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UAE supports efforts to bring peace in Syria

BACKS COUNTRY'S SOVEREIGNTY AS
ABDULLAH MEETS SYRIAN MINISTER

ABU DHABI

The UAE yesterday reaffirmed its support for Syria's independence and sovereignty over its entire territory.

During a meeting between Shaikh Abdullah Bin Zayed Al Nahyan, Deputy Prime Minister and Minister of Foreign Affairs, and Asaad Al Shaibani, Minister of Foreign Affairs in the Syrian Transitional Government, in Abu Dhabi yesterday, the UAE emphasised its solidarity with the Syrian people and its support for all regional and international efforts aimed at fulfilling their aspirations for security, peace, stability, and a dignified life.

Shaikh Abdullah underscored the importance of ensuring all necessary factors for security and stability for the Syrian people to build a future of prosperity, progress, and development.

The two top diplomats also discussed ways to enhance the strong fraternal relations between the two countries and their peoples in areas of mutual interest.

They also reviewed the overall developments in Syria and the current regional situation, in addition to tackling several issues of mutual concern.

On Sunday, the Syrian delegation met Qatar's Prime Minister Shaikh Mohammad Bin Abdulrahman Bin Jassim Al

Thani who "reiterated the State of Qatar's position in support of Syria's unity, sovereignty and independence".

US engagement

Meanwhile, US Secretary of State Antony Blinken will meet his European counterparts on Thursday in Rome on Syria, as the West looks to engage the country's new leadership.

Blinken will "meet with European counterparts to advocate for a peaceful, inclusive, Syrian-led and Syrian-owned political transition", a State Department statement said yesterday.

The Biden administration is set to offer limited sanctions relief to Syria to boost the flow of humanitarian aid. The US Treasury Department plans to authorise some transactions that will broaden the amount of humanitarian assistance flowing in Syria.

—WAM, agencies
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Shaikh Abdullah underscored the importance of ensuring all necessary factors for security and stability for the Syrian people to build a future of prosperity, progress, and development.



AFP

HEAVY RAINS FLOOD MAKKAH

A road in Makkah is inundated — with cars submerged — after heavy rains and thunderstorms hit several regions in Saudi Arabia, including Madinah and Jeddah, yesterday. The National Centre of Meteorology (NCM) said most regions in the country will experience rainfall ranging from moderate to heavy until tomorrow. **SEE ALSO P9**

Trudeau resigns as Canada PM

Will stay in office
until a successor
is chosen

OTTAWA

Canada's Prime Minister Justin Trudeau announced his resignation yesterday, saying he will leave office as soon as the ruling Liberal party chooses a new leader after months of slumping polls and internal division.

"I intend to resign as party leader, as prime minister, after the party selects its next leader," Trudeau, who has been in power since 2015, told re-



Bloomberg

■ Justin Trudeau

porters in Ottawa following a protracted political crisis that saw top Liberal allies urge him to quit.

It was not immediately clear how long Trudeau will remain in office as a caretaker premier. He said the Liberal leadership race will be "a ro-

bust, nationwide competitive process."

Trudeau's support within the Liberal party had been teetering through much of last year but plunged to new depths following the surprise resignation in December of his former finance minister and deputy prime minister Chrystia Freeland.

In a scathing resignation letter, Freeland accused Trudeau of focusing on political gimmicks to appease voters, including a costly Christmas tax holiday, instead of steady-ing Canada's finances ahead of Donald Trump's promised tariffs.

—AFP

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